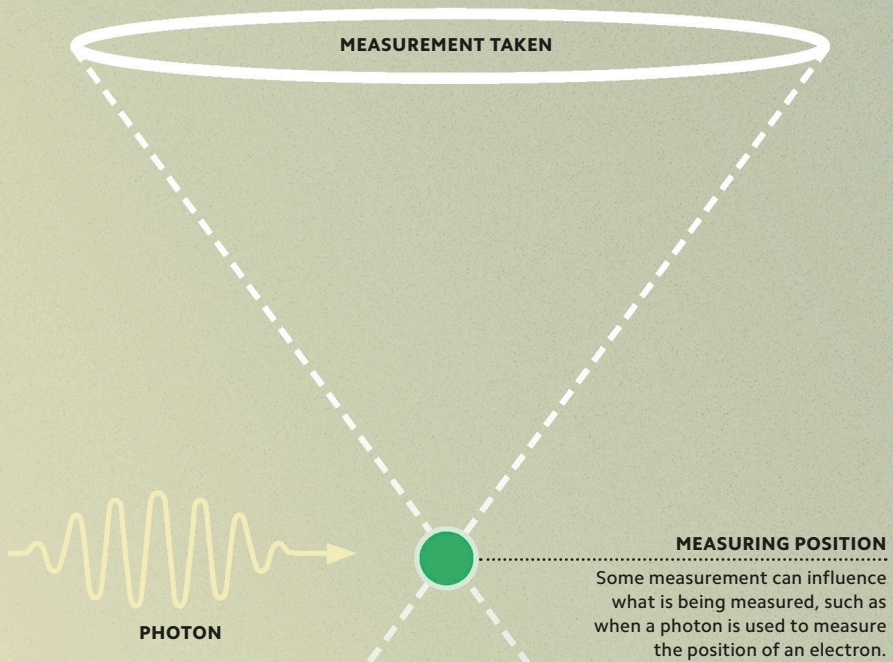




EVADING MEASUREMENT

The Schrödinger equation (see pp.44–45) describes the evolution of a wave function—giving the probability of finding the system in various states in a superposition at any given time—but when the system is measured, it is always found in a single state. It is impossible to observe the wave function of superposed states and say which will be seen when the system is measured; this mystery has led to different interpretations of quantum mechanics.